

Ubuntu Light

Canonical has announced that development on the tablet version of Ubuntu is underway and it will be merged with the netbook edition to be named as Ubuntu Light

Steam coming to Linux

Valve software will soon be releasing a Linux client which promises to provide another option for Linux gaming community

gramming and scripting with Ruby. A workshop on Blender, an open source tool used in gaming and animation acquired a lot of participation.

Further workshops included topics such as Code Documentation using Doxygen, Latex, and Wiki as a documentation tool, GNUplot for plotting and linkscape. This workshop mainly focused on the importance of documentation and how it can be done through open source.

Open invitation to participate and organise was an interesting feature in these workshops which encouraged participation and motivated other students to join LUG. For each workshop, a web page for workshop is created on the group of 250+ members, where each member can edit the page and assign the responsibility to himself. It demonstrates the work culture of an open source community.

Apart from the workshops, LUG also organised two installation demonstrations - "Install Fest" and another was during "Openhouse" 2008. In the Openhouse, LUG conducted discussions, talks and demos on various aspects of Linux, both for kids and for grown-ups.

Open source projects

The community started two open source projects - Eduvid and Free world. The project Eduvid generates vector-based education videos, that is intended to replace whiteboard teaching technique to more efficient electronic board teaching. It creates automated slideshow based on presentation timings that are recorded automatically in browser.

The idea of the free world is to create peer-to-peer communication network for sharing data and for instant messaging. The peer-to-peer network will be based on some form of network connectivity, LAN, WAN or internet.

SF-Foss @ IIITM Gwalior

Here comes Indian Institute of Information technology and Management-Gwalior working its way towards development of Open source. In collaboration with NRC-FOSS and Sun Microsystems, its student forum for Free Open Source Software (SF-Foss in short) aims at developing

various open source solutions for various problems existing in present date. The forum conducts many activities that helps it realise its ultimate goal of "Spreading Knowledge.. Unrestrained". The prime activities that took place included expert talks on a long list of topics; including Linux, Apache, MySQL, PHP attended by students of various premier technical institutes. From time to time, major events such as documentary production (on FOSS), workshops and sessions are organised in which people from various parts of the globe participated.

In order to take a leap forward in promoting open source, the following events were organised SF-FOSS:

Release of Fibonacci

Fibonacci is an international magazine published under SF-FOSS in collaboration with NRC-FOSS and SUN Microsystems.



Student's forum at IIITM Gwalior

tems. At a glance the magazine consisted of 46 articles from 41 authors from all around the world including personalities from major open source organisations such as SUN Microsystems. This magazine is downloadable at <http://sf-foss.iiitm.ac.in/fibonacci>. With over 2 lakh downloads, and articles from countries, the magazine received a tremendous response from the open source community.

Free/Open source software for higher technical education (FOSHTE)

It is a 2-day workshop organised under SF-FOSS. Several sessions were delivered by open source experts from CDAC, Delhi

and NRCFOSS. The session started with installation of BOSS (Bharat Operating System Solutions) and was followed by sessions by Dr. S. Srinivasan, NRCFOSS. This created awareness among students from various institutions in India regarding open source and its usability.

Documentary on "Growth and Evolution of Open Source Software"

This multilingual (Hindi/English) documentary focused on how open source software came into existence and the advantages that it offers. The multilingual nature helped it to percolate to the roots of the society familiar with information technology. This multilingual documentary screened at various occasions helped people in rural areas get familiar with open source technologies.



Participants engrossed during an IIITM activity

Applications developed

Two active members of SF-FOSS at IIITM Gwalior developed an open source application "File Tracking System"(FTS) that was deployed at Narcotics, Gwalior. FTS gives a solution to the problem of file tracking that exists in various organisations. This application is advantageous in many ways as the creators of FTS quote - it saves a lot of paper work and indeed paper, and secondly it keeps track of every file submitted and the application is coded to give constant reminders to the person for forwarding of a file/request/suggestion.

It is evident that if these organisations keep working with full enthusiasm and zeal, India will surely witness some great open source applications and skilled developers in near future. **d**